

Slides 3.3: Adolescence: What Is Changing and Why It Is Normal

Slide outline for Lesson 3.3. Twelve slides. Nothing on these slides is about puberty or reproductive health; those are health class. Every “you” is general. Slide 9 carries the “tell an adult” list; I fill in the counselor’s name and room.

Slide 1: Adolescence: What Is Changing and Why It Is Normal

- Lesson 3.3: Growing Across the Lifespan
- Unit 3: Growing Up, Getting Along
- Today: four things that change, a myth sort, and a rule about “normal”
- Do now: true or false, private, nobody shares: (1) Teenagers need less sleep than younger kids. (2) Your brain is finished growing by 12. (3) Mood swings mean something is wrong with you Notes: All three are false. Say so after they write, not before.

Slide 2: A brain at 13

- The bottom floors work
- The top floor is still being built
- That floor plans ahead and hits the brakes
- This is not an insult. It is a schedule Image: a construction site described in words: a building with the lower floors finished and lit, the top two floors open steel framing with a crane. Notes: Come back to this image every time a student asks “why do I...”

Slide 3: Body (a ruler)

- Growth spurts: arms and legs grow first, so you may feel clumsy for a while
- Hungrier
- The sleep clock shifts later: the body wants to fall asleep later and wake later
- School does not move, so sleep gets squeezed
- Sleep window from Lesson 2.6: 8 to 10 hours for ages 13 to 18; 9 to 12 for ages 6 to 12 Notes: Puberty questions go to health. Say the coordination line once, plainly, and move on.

Slide 4: Brain (a brain)

- The prefrontal cortex, the planning and braking part, keeps building into the mid 20s
- The part that feels reward and excitement is running at full speed now
- So risks feel bigger and better than they will later
- Friends nearby make that stronger Image: a plain side view of a brain with the front shaded and labeled “still building.” Notes: “The brakes are still being installed, which is why you practice using them now, not why you skip them.” Say it here; a student will test it later.

Slide 5: Feelings (a face)

- Bigger
- Faster
- They swing
- That is chemistry, not character Notes: One minute. Do not ask anyone how they feel.

Slide 6: Independence (a house key)

- Wanting to decide for yourself
- Wanting privacy
- Still needing family
- Both at once. That is normal Notes: Students fill the four-part chart, handout Part 1, one line per part.

Slide 7: Myth or fact

- Twelve strips. Work in pairs. Sort them into MYTH and FACT
- For each myth, one sentence: "This is a myth because ____"
- 10 minutes
- Then: stand and sort. I call a strip, you stand under the sign Image: two wall signs, MYTH and FACT, drawn as arrows. Notes: Grade 6 and IEP/504 sort eight strips. A student who does not want to stand holds up an M or F card at the seat.

Slide 8: The key

- Myths: 1, 3, 5, 7, 9, 11
- Facts: 2, 4, 6, 8, 10, 12
- Fix your sorts Notes: If more than a third stood wrong on the sleep strip (1) or the brain strip (11), reteach that slide for one minute right now.

Slide 9: "Normal" is a range

- Two people, both 13: one a head taller, one not yet. Both normal
- One asleep at 9, one at midnight. Both normal
- One cries at a movie, one does not. Both normal
- Same age is not the same stage. Late is not wrong
- Not a phase and needs an adult: sadness that does not lift for weeks; not sleeping for days; hurting yourself or someone else; a friend who says any of those
- Tell: the counselor, the nurse, any teacher, the office, an adult at home Notes: Students copy the rule and the list into the "Normal is a range" box on the handout, after Part 3. This list is the one thing nobody leaves without.

Slide 10: The case

- A 13-year-old wants to go to a friend's house on a school night
- The parent says no. The door slams. An hour later both feel bad
- What is the 13-year-old's brain doing? What is the parent doing?
- Write one response that fits the brain at this age, and one reason

- Response bank: ask again when calm; offer a plan; name the feeling; write it instead of saying it Notes: Pairs compare. Two pairs share by choice. Land it: waiting for calm is the brake pedal.

Slide 11: Exit card

- 3 things that change in adolescence, one per part
- 2 myths you can now correct
- 1 question for the health teacher (optional; no name goes with it) Notes: The “1” lines go to the health teacher with no names. Two students read a “2” aloud.

Slide 12: Tomorrow

- Heredity, environment, and who you are becoming
- Then a review game and the Lifespan Stages Quiz (day 2)
- Bring your handouts from 3.1, 3.2, and 3.3 Notes: Two of the myth strips are on the quiz.